bringing together judiciary, justice, prosecutorial and police functions around a system that can work and in which people gradually assume a confidence of posture.

Narcotics remains a major question. It is in fact clearly one of the most important issues. It is frequently cited that 93 percent of the world's heroin originates in Afghanistan, even after in fact we have become, at least for all intents and purposes the military masters of that country in terms of when, where and how we wish to present ourselves on the ground there. In lieu, we believe, of massive eradication attempts we need an approach that can help to build a permanent effort upon current cultivators' part to be committed to alternatives. It has been fascinating to me, I do not think it is believable but nevertheless it is consistently repeated, and there may be a kernel of truth in this, that a very large percentage of Afghans engaged in narcotics production at least are willing to say to investigators they would take half the income if they could find a legitimate alternative crop to engage in. We need to test that. If in fact only half those people are telling the truth we are further ahead than I think we are in terms of current approaches toward that issue.

And I have had the ''pleasure'' indeed, and I use that word in quotations, of dealing with narcotics issues on a number of continents in a number of jobs in the past.

Economic development and reconstruction is badly lagging. We need Afghans to support the effort. We need a central focus in their government on making that happen. And as has been said several times, we need quickly to follow up the clearance of Taliban and other forces from provinces, towns and cities with development assistance.

Finally, the neighborhood and your focus. We need to embark on a long-term and sustained effort to reduce traditional antagonisms between Afghanistan and Pakistan. And, indeed, the border area is heavily dominated by the Pashtuns. And true, in working with them, despite the enormous tribal animosities there needs to be a way to begin the process of building back some kind of confidence and indeed shaking their current faith in the Taliban, faith which I think in part is imposed and faith which is in part derived from their desire somehow to avoid central control. Extremist madrassahs and training camps are a beginning place to move. Encouraging the relaxation of Pakistani restrictions on the movement of legitimate goods in an out of Afghanistan will be a help.

We need to find a way to deal with the long-term and somewhat dangerous dispute between Afghanistan and Pakistan over the actual border between the two countries. This will not happen right away but it is something we need to work on.

With respect to Pakistan itself, Dick I think has more than adequately summarized the question. We no longer have, if indeed we ever had, a single individual on whom we can rely in the war on terror in Afghanistan.

Secondly, we now have an electoral process: Parties that have moved to the fore as a result of democratic competition, parties which are strange bedfellows historically and which have had not, in my view, a fantastically remarkable track record either in governments or indeed in honesty in government. They will somehow now have to be dealt with in a new conundrum to move them ahead. They will have to assume the responsibility, I believe, for trying to make progress in the FATA area. Many have suggested——

Chairman Berman. Mr. Ambassador, I am going to have to interrupt.

Ambassador Pickring. I will finish with two sentences.

Chairman Berman. Okay. I yield.

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